Pacing & Scene Length

There is one golden rule in editing short-form:

If something feels too long → cut it.

Short-form rewards speed, clarity and rhythm.

This section is about building that rhythm.

Step 1: Place the Voiceover First

Always start by importing your downloaded voiceover from Elevenlabs onto the timeline.

The voiceover sets the structure.

Before adding anything else:

Adjust the volume.

ElevenLabs audio is often slightly too quiet.

Personally, I increase mine by around **+10 dB** (depending on the clip).

Voiceover should always be dominant over music later.

Step 2: Add Your Animated Scenes

Now import your animations from:

- Kling
- or Veo3

Place them under the voiceover and align them to the narration.

You can:

- Generate all animations first and then edit
  OR
- Edit progressively as you generate scenes

Sometimes editing as you go is easier because you won't need to search later which scene belongs where.

Step 3: Trim & Speed Adjust

Cut every animation to match the sentence.

If extra footage remains:

- Trim it
  OR
- Speed it up

I often speed clips up even to **200%** if necessary.

If a section contains little movement from the character, cut that part.

Never leave dead seconds.

Step 4: Add Subtle Zoom (Optional)

If an animation feels too static, you can add a subtle zoom-in effect.

Two options:

Option A – Manual Keyframes

- Add keyframe at start: Scale 100%
- Add keyframe at end: Scale 110%

This creates a subtle cinematic push-in.

Option B – Built-in Effects (CapCut only)

CapCut has ready-made zoom effects.

You can simply apply a zoom-in effect from the Effects tab.

This helps when:

- Kling movement is minimal
- Scene feels flat
- You want extra cinematic depth

It’s not mandatory.

But it helps.

Step 5: Subtle Shake for Static Shots

If a shot feels too still, you can add a slight shake effect.

In CapCut, this effect is called:

“Light Shake”

Step 6: Hook Structure (Very Important)

At the very start of the video - during the hook question - use **4–5 of the strongest animations from the entire video.**

The first 2–3 seconds are important.

Step 7: Transitions Between Major Scenes

When transitioning between major time blocks like:

- Day 1
- Day 2
- Day 3
- Year 4

Add a transition.

In Premiere Pro, I use:

Liquid Distortion

In CapCut, a good option is:

“Shake X”

Keep transitions fast and clean.

Do not overuse them.

They should emphasize progression, not distract.

Step 8: Light Color & Sharpness Boost

At the end, you can slightly boost:

- Saturation
- Contrast
- Sharpness

But be careful.

Over-editing can:

- destroy detail
- create artificial look
- lower perceived quality

Always watch the preview carefully.

Subtle enhancement > aggressive correction.

Final Reminder

If a scene drags → cut.
If it feels static → zoom or shake lightly.